SUPERSTORE SALES REPORT

Data Science & Analytics Internship Task 1

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FUTURE INTERNS

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Executive Summary

In the analysis that was done for the Superstore over the analysed period, it is evident that the outlet is performing at an adequate level. Total revenue in the analysed period reached $2.30 million across roughly 5,000 orders, and over 38,000 units sold, driven heavily by strong performances in the west and east regions, which each brought in an estimated revenue of $725,000 and $678,000 respectively. The top performing product is Staples, with over 200 units sold during the analysed period, while the top performing category is Technology, accounting for roughly 36.4%, and generating roughly $836,000. However, the category that dominated sales, was Office supplies by 60.48%, with sales reaching over 22,900 units sold.

Part 1: Revenue Trends & Seasonality

When analysing sales, the first thing that becomes visible is the poor start to the year, with the retail outlet recording their lowest monthly revenue of the year in January ($95,000) and February ($60,000). In March, there is a sudden spike in revenue, before it drops, and levels, from April till August. From September onwards, we see an exponential increase in revenue, with it reaching its highest of the year in November and December, directly contrasting the poorer performance of January and February.

Given this analysis, there’s reason to believe that this revenue peak might be directly linked to the holidays, since the holiday season traditionally kicks off in late November. The middle of the year was level, indicating that demand had settled for the year post the March bump.

The Recommendations that I’ll give to Superstore, is that they should introduce new-year sales, specifically for office supplies, aimed at lowering prices to entice the business owners looking to stock up for the upcoming business year. Then, the outlet should also look into end-of-year/holiday sales, especially for technologies, aimed at families looking to buy gifts for the holiday season. This should drive up sales substantially across those 2 key quarters.

Part 2: Product & Category Breakdown

During the analysis period, the product that garnered the most sale in terms of units sold, was Staples, followed by Staple Envelopes and Easy-Staple Paper. When it comes to categories, it's a tale of two halves; Technology dominated total revenue, while having the least number of units sold, whereas Office Supplies dominated unit sales, while generating the least amount of revenue. Furniture came second in both revenue and units sold.

Based off this trend, paying closer attention to Technology and Office Supplies, it paints a picture on the pricing structure of the two categories. While Technology had the lowest number of units sold, it generated the most revenue, suggesting that products under Technology sell at a high price. On the side of Office Supplies, it had the highest unit sales, while also bringing in the least amount of revenue, suggesting that its products are priced much lower.

My recommendation, based on the above analysis, is to explore raising the price of products under Office Supplies, not by a lot, but just enough that it brings in even more revenue, especially since it has been the highest selling category by unit sales. Another recommendation is for the outlet to explore why Technology is selling the least, and whether it has anything to do with its high prices, to try and place it at a level that allows more buyers to buy the product, given the elasticity of Technology, while keeping it at a highly-profitable level.

Part 3: Regional Performance

When it comes to regional performance, of the 4 regions involved, its quickly clear how the scales are tipped. The West region is the best performing region in terms of revenue performance, with the East very close by. On the other end of the spectrum, however, the South is the worst performing region, with the central region being not that far ahead.

This shows that both the East and the West regions account for over 60% of the outlet's revenue income, with the South and Central regions accounted for under 40% of the revenue income.

My recommendation to Superstore is that they should investigate what might be leading to the lower performance in the South and Central regions, and maybe strategies their regional pricing model to try and draw in more buyers from these two regions. Another suggestion is to invest more of their marketing budget into the two regions to up their marketing campaigns, in hope of drawing the attention of more customers. While doing all of this to draw in more income from the underperforming regions, they shouldn't neglect the higher-performing West & East Regions. They should capitalise on this by considering introducing incentives, such as loyalty programs, that can persuade current buyers into staying with the outlet and, potentially, draw in more customers.

Conclusion

Fruitful analyses were made from this analysis period, and with it came some actionable recommendations. These included:

- For Revenue:
  - Introducing New-Year Sales, targeting businesses looking to stock up on office supplies for the year.
  - Introducing Holiday Sales, aimed at families wanting to but technologies as gifts.
- For Products & Categories:
  - A more aggressive pricing model for the Office Supply category, aimed at taking advantage of it being the best-selling category in terms of unit sales.
  - Revisiting the price of Technology products and pricing it a bit lower than what it is to drive up sales, without losing profitability.
- Regional Performance:
  - Introducing a more dynamic pricing model and new marketing campaigns to draw more customers in the lower-performing regions.
  - Introducing incentives that help with customer retention in the higher-performing regions.

I believe that, with these recommendations, we could see an even bigger increase in revenue generation, and unit sales, across all products, categories, and regions.